MINDJE KAYUMBA PATIENT, PhD

CONTACT

Address:
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Date and Place of birth: 05th January 1997-RWANDA/Kigali
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A dynamic, result-oriented, and highly productive PhD graduate in Physical Geography with expertise in GIS, spatial analysis, and land-change sustainability. Possessing advanced research and analytical skills, I am a fast learner and an open-minded team player passionate about applying innovative, data-driven approaches to address complex environmental and sustainability challenges.

Interests: Geospatial Analysis for Sustainable Development | Climate–Land Interactions | Environmental Risk and Vulnerability Assessment | Sustainable Land Management | Spatial Decision Support Systems | Earth Observation for Policy and Planning

EDUCATION

2022-2026: PhD Candidate in Physical geography
University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Xinjiang Institute of Ecology and Geography

Thesis: "*Terrestrial ecosystem health and sustainability in Central Asia*"

2019-2022: Master's Degree in Physical geography
University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Xinjiang Institute of Ecology and Geography

2015-2018: Bachelor of Science in Environmental management and Conservation
University of Lay Adventist of Kigali (UNILAK).

2011-2014: Advanced Level Certificate (A_2) in Biology

and Chemistry at Groupe Scolaire Consulaire

Congolais, Kigali, Rwanda

SKILLS AND COMPETENCES

Technical & Laboratory Skills

Spatial Data Analysis | Remote Sensing Image Processing | Land Change Detection | Environmental Modelling | Geospatial Data Interpretation | Data Collection and Digitization

Personal Strengths

Excellent Communication and Interpersonal Skills | Leadership and Team Collaboration | Strong Analytical Thinking | Organizational Skills | Writing skills | Adaptability in Multicultural Environments

Software & Tools

R (RStudio) | ArcGIS | QGIS | TerrSet | Google Earth Engine | Microsoft Office Suite | Photoshop | AI tools

PROJECTS INVOLVEMENT

-Green Investment Mobilization to Support Rwanda's Planned Expansion of the Volcanoes National Park (VNP)

-Strategic Priority Research Program of the Chinese Academy of Sciences (XDA19030204)

-The Key Research Program of the Chinese Academy of Sciences (ZDRWZS-2019-3)

- National Natural Science Foundation of China (U1903208,41630859)
- National Key Research and Development Program (2019YFA0606902)
- The National Natural Science Foundation of China (U1903208).
- Youth Innovation Promotion Association of the Chinese Academy of Sciences (No. 2019431).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

June – Dec 2022

Apprentice, Global Green Growth Institute (GGGI), Rwanda

- Contributed to green investment mobilization initiatives
- Project and Resource mobilization to support the expansion of Volcanoes National Park
- Workshop organizers: Capacity Building workshop on market-based mechanisms under article 6 of the Paris agreement to support the volcanoes national park expansion-GGGI
- Knowledge sharing o GIS utility in park monitoring

Feb 2023 – Present

Assistant Lecturer, University of Lay Adventists of Kigali,

- Teaching Environmental Studies and related courses
- Supervising undergraduate research projects
- Supporting curriculum development and academic mentorship

May – June 2022

Assistant Lecturer, University of Rwanda

- Delivered lectures on Applications of GIS and Remote Sensing in Agroforestry and Nature Conservation
- Assisted in practical GIS and spatial data analysis training

Leadership & Service

2018 – 2019: Advisor, Conservation for Life Club, UNILAK

2016 – 2018: President, Conservation for Life Club, UNILAK

2015 – 2017: Vice President, Aspire Debate Club (UNILAK-ADC)

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

2022: Excellent International Student

University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Xinjiang Institute of Ecology and Geography, China

2018: Best Student in Environmental Studies Faculty (First Class)

University of Lay Adventists of Kigali (UNILAK), Rwanda

2018 – 3rd Best English Debater at *UNILAK Inter-Department Debate Championship, Rwanda*

2018 – Recognition for Youth Conservation Innovation Poster

Conservation on Conservation Conference, Rwanda

TRAINING AND CONFERENCES

2022

- Presentation in Research symposium on soil science, crossing boundaries and sustainable agriculture in Rwanda

Topic presented: Modelling the near-surface energies and water vapor fluxes across an agroecosystem

2020

- **Presenter** in the annual meeting of Xinjiang state key laboratory of desert and oasis ecology

Topic presented: Spatial ecological risk assessment of Bayanbulak wetland in Northwestern China

June 2016

- 3rd international conference on environment energy, disaster, and development (ICEED).

Theme: Future we want sustainability for all Place: Kigali, Rwanda

March 2018

- Participated in a training workshop on Landscape Approach to Forest Restoration and Conservation (LAFREC)

Theme: *"Enhancing environmental services, climate resilience and sustainable lives in the Gishwati-Mukura Landscape. Organized by Rwanda Environmental management and Authority (REMA)*

August 2017

- KWITA IZINA 3rd conversation on conservation Forum.

Theme: *Conservation in the Face of Climate Change Conservation, a Collective Responsibility.*

Place: KCVE (Kigali conference and exhibition village).

September 2018

- KWITA IZINA Conversation on Conservation.

Theme: *Advancing conservation with technology*

Place: KCVE (Kigali conference and exhibition village).

SERVICES AND COMMUNITY OUTREACH

2019

Visiting and inspiring Young desperate youths in the Gikondo sector of Kigali city-Rwanda through Global Community Partners (Visiting place: Best family, Gikondo)

2018

Teaching and raising awareness among secondary school students on environmental protection (Kagugu primary school) through ADRRES "*Advocacy to disaster risk reduction and environmental sustainability*"

2018

Tree plantation campaign through the environmental club at UNILAK (Conservation for Life Club)

LANGUAGES

English: Very Fluent
French: Very Fluent
Chinese mandarin: Good
Swahili: Very Fluent
Kinyarwanda: Very Fluent

PERSON OF REFERENCES

1. **Michelle DeFreese**
Project Manager, Pacific Community (SPC)
Email: defreese.michelle@gmail.com

2. **Dr. Zhi Li**
Professor, Chinese Academy of Sciences, Xinjiang institute of Ecology and Geography
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3. **MUPENZI Christophe**

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